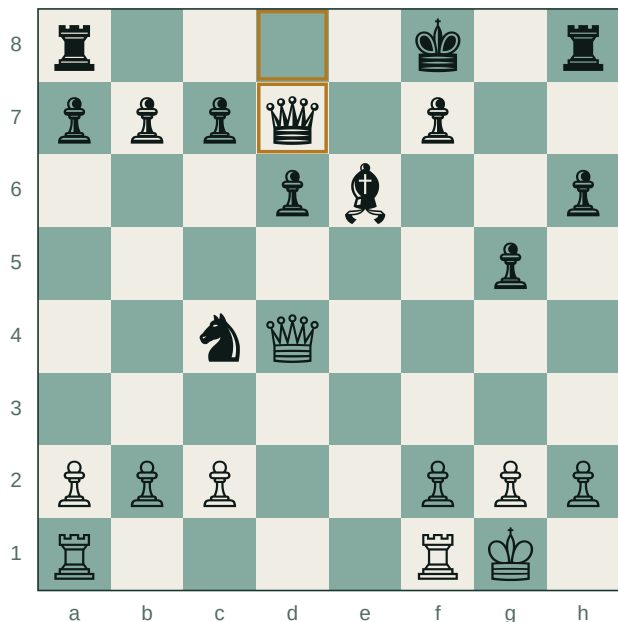


Skewers: White, move 17

Skewers

White to move



Previous move: 16...Qxd7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

17. Qxh8+ Ke7 18. Qxa8

17.Qxh8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on h8. Recorded reply: **17...Ke7**.

18.Qxa8 The queen captures the rook on a8.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +10. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +10: the balance goes from -7 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A skewer puts the more important target in front. When that target moves, a piece behind it may be lost. Checks make the geometry especially forcing.

HOW TO LOOK

Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on f8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.